



Digital Art Imaging 1

OPTIMA ACADEMY ONLINE · FAMILY COURSE OVERVIEW · GRADES 9–12 · ELECTIVE

~4¼ hrs per week · 50 min/day, M–F

About this overview. This document is an example of how the course might be taught. More artworks and projects are approved for this course than appear here, so scholars may see some variation in works studied and projects from course to course, and between the live school and On-Demand. Each teacher also leans into their own strengths and passions; the structure, expectations, and time commitment below are representative of the course as designed.

Digital Art Imaging teaches scholars to think visually and express ideas clearly through digital creation. Building on centuries of visual art practice, the course shows how cameras, software, and digital tools extend the artist's ability to capture, compose, and communicate. Through photography, digital painting, and graphic design, scholars develop precision in their work and care in how they present ideas, engaging contemporary tools — including VR and AI — while mastering the timeless principles of composition and visual thinking. The result is both technical skill and genuine visual literacy.

THE YEAR AT A GLANCE

1 Digital Photography (strand)

Capturing and composing with the camera as an artist's tool.

3 Graphic Design (strand)

Communicating ideas clearly through type, layout, and image.

5 Contemporary Tools (woven through)

VR and AI tools engaged thoughtfully for exploring, refining, and presenting work.

2 Digital Painting (strand)

Creating original imagery with digital brushes, layers, and color.

4 Composition and Visual Thinking (all year)

The Elements of Art and Principles of Design as the working grammar of every piece.

6 The Growing Portfolio (all year)

Finished works and artist statements accumulate in an organized OneDrive portfolio across the year.

A TYPICAL WEEK

- Optima art courses run on a two-week cycle.
- Week 1: look closely at real artworks and images, learn the cycle's concept and technique, and complete exercise and sketch work.
- Week 2: create the cycle's finished piece and submit it with a short artist statement — every finished work is signed.
- Critique uses the Elements of Art and Principles of Design as its shared vocabulary.

TIME COMMITMENT

250 minutes / week

≈ 50 minutes a day, Monday–Friday

- Daily lesson, exercise, and studio time fill most of the scheduled minutes.
- Finished-piece weeks may run longer as work is refined and presented.

WHAT SCHOLARS NEED

- A computer with reliable internet and access to Canvas.
- A digital camera (a phone camera works) for photography strands.
- Microsoft 365 and OneDrive (provided to every scholar) for the portfolio; creative software as directed in the course.

On-Demand (asynchronous). Scholars move through the course at their own pace, with due dates to keep the year on track. An Optima teacher is available throughout for support, feedback, and grading.

Live school. Live-school scholars take this same course on Optima's VR campus with a teacher and classmates, meeting daily on the school's schedule.